

Tech Skills for Femalepreneurs

A Free One-Day Online Training for Young Female Entrepreneurs — IWD 2023 Theme:
DigitALL: Innovation and Technology for Gender Equality

GDGF organised a free one-day Zoom training for young female entrepreneurs in celebration of IWD 2023. Digital expert Eugene Ogbeide delivered two practical modules: Graphic Design using Canva and Google My Business. The training was coordinated by Programme Manager Faith Okonobo and reached 30 participants across 8 Nigerian states plus Cardiff, Wales (UK).

Organisation	Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF)
Date	March 11, 2023 (IWD 2023 week)
IWD Theme	DigitALL: Innovation and Technology for Gender Equality
Format	Free one-day online training via Zoom
Training Modules	Module 1: Graphic Design using Canva · Module 2: Google My Business
Trainer	Eugene Ogbeide — paid digital expert
Programme Manager	Faith Okonobo
Participants	30 participants (March 2023)
Geographic Reach	8 Nigerian states · Cardiff, Wales, UK

30

Participants

2

Training Modules

8+

States & Countries

Free

Cost to Participants

Overview

In celebration of International Women's Day 2023, under the United Nations theme 'DigitALL: Innovation and Technology for Gender Equality,' Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF) organised a free one-day online training for young female entrepreneurs on March 11, 2023. The training was delivered via Zoom by paid digital expert Eugene Ogbeide and coordinated by GDGF Programme Manager Faith Okonobo.

The training covered two practical, immediately applicable digital skills modules: Graphic Design using Canva and Google My Business. These two topics were chosen to address the most critical gaps identified in GDGF's target audience — the ability to create professional visual content independently, and the ability to make a business discoverable online without technical expertise or significant cost.

30 participants registered and attended across 8 Nigerian states and Cardiff, Wales (UK). Every participant indicated willingness to provide feedback on the training's impact. The initiative received overwhelmingly positive responses with participants sharing inspiring testimonies about its effect on their businesses.

IWD 2023 context: The UN theme 'DigitALL' highlighted the digital gender gap — women and girls remain significantly underrepresented in technology-driven economic spaces. GDGF's training directly operationalised this theme at grassroots level: putting two high-impact digital tools — Canva and Google My Business — in the hands of 30 female entrepreneurs, free of charge, in a single day.

Training Modules

Module 1: Graphic Design using Canva

Canva is a free, browser-based design tool that enables non-designers to create professional-quality graphics for social media posts, business flyers, logos, presentations, and marketing materials. For small female entrepreneurs who cannot afford professional graphic designers, Canva represents a transformative equaliser — the ability to produce polished, branded visual content independently.

Participant registration responses confirmed this was one of the most urgently needed skills in the cohort, with multiple entrepreneurs specifically naming Canva as a tool they wanted to learn. Eugene Ogbeide's session equipped participants with the practical ability to design for their own businesses immediately after the training.

Why Canva matters for this audience: 40% of participants ran fashion or clothing businesses — sectors where visual presentation is central to sales. A participant who can independently design a professional Instagram post, product flyer, or brand logo has a direct competitive advantage over peers who cannot.

Module 2: Google My Business

Google My Business (now Google Business Profile) is a free tool that enables businesses to appear in Google Search and Google Maps results — making them discoverable by customers who are actively searching for their products or services. For a small Nigerian business selling fashion, food, or events services, a verified Google Business listing provides credibility, visibility, and access to customers far beyond existing social networks.

Several participants had explicitly identified Google Business registration as a priority need in their registration forms — recognising that being discoverable online was the gap between a local business and a growing one. Eugene Ogbeide's session walked participants through the setup and optimisation process step by step.

Why Google My Business matters for this audience: Most of the 30 participants had been in business for 1–3 years and relied on WhatsApp and personal referral for customer acquisition. A Google Business listing extends reach to people who have never heard of the business — turning online searches into potential sales, without paid advertising.

Trainer and Programme Team

Eugene Ogbeide — Digital Expert and Trainer

GDGF contracted Eugene Ogbeide as a paid digital expert to design and deliver both training modules. Commissioning an external specialist — rather than delivering in-house — ensured participants received professional-quality, current, practical instruction on tools that require genuine digital expertise to teach effectively.

Faith Okonobo — Programme Manager

GDGF Programme Manager Faith Okonobo coordinated the full event — managing registration, participant communications, Zoom logistics, and post-training follow-up. The programme management structure ensured smooth delivery across multiple states and time zones.

Participant Profile

Age Range	Participants	% of Total
16 – 20	2	7%
21 – 25	19	63%
26 – 30	5	17%
30 – 35	3	10%
Above 35	1	3%
Total	30	100%

Geographic Reach

Location	Participants	Notes
Delta State	16	Largest cohort — GDGF's home state
Lagos State	4	Nigeria's commercial capital
Anambra State	3	South-East Nigeria
Ogun State	2	South-West Nigeria
Oyo State	2	South-West Nigeria
Bayelsa State	2	South-South Nigeria

Edo State	1	South-South Nigeria
Imo State	1	South-East Nigeria
Cardiff, Wales (UK)	1	Nigerian diaspora — international reach

Business Sectors Represented

Sector	Count
Fashion, clothing & fabrics	12
Events & hospitality	4
Food, baking & pastries	3
Craft & handmade products	3
Healthcare	1
Technology & data	1
Other (jewellery, soap, household, copywriting)	6

How Participants Heard About the Training

Channel	Participants	% of Total
WhatsApp	15	50%
Word of mouth / Friend	12	40%
Instagram	2	7%
Facebook / LinkedIn	1	3%

Participant Voices

Selected registration responses showing the specific needs the two training modules directly addressed — in participants' own words:

"This training would help promote my business through Canva app and also teach me how to register my business on Google."

— Okeya Precious, fashion entrepreneur, Delta State

"It will give me the opportunity to take my business to the social world via social media, help me stand out in social media management and also make my business page look well presentable due to the help of Canva design."

— Chukwuedo Grace, craft business, Imo State

"I need this training... placing my business on Google for easier means of customer service and availability, which will raise more customers for my business within my region and locality."

— Okeke Ekene Hope, bakery, Anambra State

"The world is now in a digital stage — if you want what you have to be seen, you have to be digital."

— Nkamnebe Vivian Njideka, clothing, Anambra State

"I want to learn how to manage my Instagram page when posting pictures and how to increase insight... how to create attractive content on my page."

— Gajah Tamarapreye Jessica, fashion, Delta State

Outcomes and Impact

30 female entrepreneurs trained in two practical digital skills

Graphic Design using Canva and Google My Business — two tools with immediate, direct application to every business in the cohort, regardless of sector — were taught free of charge to 30 entrepreneurs in a single day.

High-impact skills for zero cost

Both Canva and Google My Business are free tools. The training equipped participants to use them professionally — transforming a zero-cost resource into a business growth asset. This multiplier effect means the investment in the trainer pays forward indefinitely.

8 Nigerian states plus international reach

The Zoom format enabled GDGF to reach female entrepreneurs from Delta to Anambra, Lagos to Bayelsa — and into the Nigerian diaspora in Cardiff, Wales. No in-person event could have achieved this geographic spread.

100% feedback commitment

All 30 participants confirmed willingness to provide feedback on the training's impact — reflecting high engagement and investment in the programme's outcomes.

IWD theme translated into direct community action

GDGF translated the UN's 'DigitALL' theme from aspiration into action — equipping 30 women with specific, named digital tools on International Women's Day week, at no cost to participants.

Programme Summary

Category	Details
Date	March 11, 2023 (IWD 2023 week)
Training modules	Module 1: Graphic Design using Canva Module 2: Google My Business
Trainer	Eugene Ogbeide (paid digital expert)
Programme Manager	Faith Okonobo

Platform	Zoom (free for participants)
Participants	30 (March 2023)
Age majority	21–25 years (63%)
Business experience	1–3 years (78%)
States reached	Delta · Lagos · Anambra · Ogun · Oyo · Bayelsa · Edo · Imo
International	Cardiff, Wales, UK
Primary discovery	WhatsApp (50%) and word of mouth (40%)
Feedback commitment	100% of participants confirmed willingness
Reception	Overwhelmingly positive with inspiring testimonies

Learning and Recommendations

The two-module format — Canva and Google My Business — proved sharply aligned with participant needs. Participant registration responses had independently identified both tools by name before the training, confirming that topic selection was evidence-based. Future editions should survey participants in advance to continue this alignment.

90% of participants discovered the training through WhatsApp and personal referral. Structured WhatsApp outreach remains GDGF's most powerful recruitment channel for this audience and should be maintained as the primary promotion tool.

The 100% feedback commitment is a documentation asset. Capturing specific post-training outcomes — businesses registered on Google, first sales from a Canva-designed flyer, Instagram growth — would build a powerful evidence base for future grant applications.

Commissioning Eugene Ogbeide as a paid specialist set a quality standard the Foundation should maintain. A recurring annual IWD training programme — with two or three targeted digital skill modules per edition — would build a consistent brand presence in this space.

The Cardiff, Wales participant signals diaspora reach that active promotion through diaspora networks could significantly expand.

Team

- Eugene Ogbeide — Digital Expert and Trainer (Graphic Design using Canva · Google My Business)
- Faith Okonobo — Programme Manager, GDGF
- Girls for Development Goals Foundation — organising body
- The 30 female entrepreneurs who attended, engaged, and committed to sharing their impact